

CIRS Monthly Magazine

THE CROSSROADS

Masquerade 2025



'CHILDREN ARE NOT VESSELS TO BE FILLED, BUT LAMPS TO BE LIT'

SWAMI CHINMAYANANDA

The Crossroads

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MASQUERAGE ISSUE

November - December 2025



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CROSS Busters
A specially curated set of movies which inspire and educate

EDITORIAL



What does it mean to be a child? In today's world, 'being a child' is reduced to a petty insult. A stage every kid can't wait to pass. But to what avail? What is the hype with 'growing up?' I personally never wanted to grow up. Be it going on an epic space expedition in the comfort of my room or reading through the endless fun of *Enid Blyton* and *Roald Dahl*, I just didn't see the utility of becoming a big boy. Looking at lots of adults dragging along cheerless existences was a pretty big turnoff to becoming one, but alas! Here I am, unable to control my growth and with it the knowledge that allows me to explore the world and myself. And all that vast knowledge of the universe blatantly agreed with my initial empiricism of my aversion to adulthood. Needless to say, all this 'kiddish' business is something society scoffs. But, it is also something that we as a human race are in dire need of.

Not a vigorous appending to the world population, or even some miracle age-reversing *super pill*. I'm talking about actively remembering the stage of life we all experienced and taking the best from it.

All the innate qualities of a child that are not only endearing, but critical in today's world. Adulthood to many is burdened with the attitude that they *learnt enough* and thinking becomes straight up boring. What we fail to understand is that being boring is not when you have absolutely nothing to do, it's when none of the options available to you appeal to you. And absolutely everything appeals to a child. On average, a kid asks around 300 questions a day, to keep in perspective that's sometimes 300 more questions asked than your average uncle and auntie.

Children live in a world where curiosity triumphs reasoning and acceptance is overshadowed by wonder. In layman's terms, kids aren't bound by the mental shackles of *thinking logically* which basically means dismissing anything that doesn't fall in with the closed off belief systems most adults carry. Their brains process on unprecedented levels, firing twice as many neurons as an average adult. Before age 7, their brains live in mostly theta brain waves which are the very waves that render a dream-like state in humans and are associated with relaxation and deep learning. They literally chill constantly in a state monks spend years to achieve! But the 'x factor' that truly separates the kiddos is their indispensable quality of faith. We might stumble upon a child playing with a cardboard box or a stick, but that very child is either constructing her very own rocket or brandishing his legendary sword. Belief is a powerful emotion that keeps people going. Childhood isn't a stage of ignorance and foolishness but rather a stage where we can observe raw unfiltered genius, where imagination outruns what we believe to be logic.



This phenomenon can be formally traced back to the 1960s when NASA was tinkering to find a way to train divergent thinkers, on astronomical levels. They ended up holding a creativity test, which despite being made for NASA engineers, had a truly magnificent effect on children. 98% of children aged 4 - 5 scored in the 'genius' category for divergent thinking, at age 10, it dwindled to a mere 30% and as the grand finale, only 2% of adults above 25 years of age scored at that level. This is cold hard evidence of the fact that almost every child in the world has the potential to be the next big creative geniuses, only to be hammered by the school system, battered by the lack of awareness and the final lethal blow reserved for social conformity. All culminating in those priceless qualities going down the drain as little kids go down to the real world. The black and white realm I never wanted to step foot in.

But amongst the dreary monotony, there are tiny slivers of color. People who embrace the gift of childhood and refuse to give in to society's superficial expectations. From Albert Einstein's 'stupid questions' that paved the way to relativity to our very own Gurudev who kept the marvel to learn as one of his cornerstones to teaching our itihasa and is even famous for the quote,

"The mind of a child is fresh, simple, and unconditioned. Keep that mind – that is meditation."

There unfortunately is no stopping growing up and it's up to us to constantly stay inquisitive and learn from the children of the world. And one more downside to being an adult, Children's Day is not yours anymore! So this children's day, let us all take that much needed trip down memory lane and to reminisce and revel in our childhood glory because I for one truly miss that!



THE SPARK OF CURIOSITY

- Disha Piya Bhimani | XI Sci

Picture falling asleep. Right after reading scientific books and encyclopedias, you fall into the world of your imagination. As you aspire to join the armed forces, you love the way defensive missiles and vehicles work. You dream of touching one of the best aircrafts made by your country, and get to take a seat in the cockpit of that very machine! Or perhaps, you hope for a different dream, located at a well-renowned science center, where you find yourself exploring a world that feels like an exhilarating realm of magic - the magic of science.

Readers, when I mention the magic of science, where do your thoughts go? Certainly not to dusty old tomes written God knows when. Instead, it pricks at you, provoking your thoughts - doesn't it? You start pondering about it, and really start thinking, which is when you begin asking questions. This thirst to know, to discover anything and everything under the sun is the state of mind which we call; curiosity- the unending thirst to know, to understand and to explore.

And it is that very feeling, the urge to question the 'why' behind everything, which reminds me of my physics teacher. He is the kind of teacher who guides you through this mystical world, ensuring you broaden your horizons. He reminds you that curiosity is not just about answering questions or reaching a new solution, but instead, is enjoying the process of you literally diving into the fascinating world of the questions itself.

Whenever he talks about "THINKING", my referential memory directly connects it to curiosity. In fact, his favorite phrase that he keeps reiterating is "Start Thinking!". Now a common question that arises in any beginner's mind is "What should I think about?" or perhaps, "Why must I keep thinking?" Some might even realise that "I am thinking about thinking itself".

But, my dear physics teacher would probably shoot back with, "Are you truly thinking about how things work around you?", or with "Do you actually think you are curious enough to know how you are even able to stand, sit and read this very article?", or my favorite, "What scientific principles enable you to write it on a mere piece of paper?"

Whenever he poses such questions, the whole class falls silent - not because we do not know the typical answers we could give, but because we start thinking beyond them. In fact, I find myself wondering about things I have never paid attention to before. It's through all these instances, that I realise how powerful curiosity is.

I accept that curiosity might lead us to an infinite amount of mistakes, but those mistakes end up as stepping stones, all of which lead to the end goal of learning. Well known scientists like Newton, Einstein and C.V.

Raman did not stop at knowing that something existed. They kept questioning 'Why' and 'How', experimenting even when the answers seemed impossibly far away.

I wonder sometimes, "What would happen if people stopped exploring and asking questions?"

Perhaps there would be no more wonder left to experience. Or perhaps, we would still end up somewhere new. It is in our nature to question, to discover. After all, even if we fail to find answers, we inevitably end up entering the beautiful world of exploration and learning.

So the next time you look at the stars, a gadget or even a simple object around you, do not hesitate to think, nor to question. Let those "Whats", "Whys" and "Hows" lead you into a world of wonder. Because every question you ask, unlocks a new shelf of knowledge in a library, that is your mind.

Ignite yourself with the very word - *Curiosity*

Curiosity should not be a mere word in your mind, it should be a question that awakens in every aspiring child's heart, every enquiring mind and in every dedicated scientist's imagination.

So readers, start being curious and let your curiosity grow so deep that even in your dreams, you keep questioning and stay curious. And always remember - *curious minds are the most efficient, intelligent and ever-developing minds.*

CROSS BUSTERS



The Secret Life Of
Walter Mitty
- 2013 film



Little Miss Sunshine
2006 film



Boyhood
2014 film

Almost every child wishes to grow up quickly, while adults often long for their carefree youth. The Crossbusters offers a curated catalogue that allows adults to revisit their childhood and provides children with opportunities to explore and enjoy life fully.

THE SOLUTION TO *grief*

There was once a wise wise man
With only 3 pennies in his can
A shimmering smile lit his face
As he strolled through life's race

While he sat thinking and thinking
Upon wisdom untold, unblinking
The villagers simply gazed
At this man so unfazed

Unfazed by tariffs and trade
By rubies and jades
Succumbed to serenity
Perhaps identical to divinity

All morn' he sat writing poetry and prose
From dawn till dusk without a pause
He wrote and wrote till his arms were sore
Till the court of the king could take no more

Such were the wits of the wise wise man
Who had only 3 pennies in his can
Yet a soul so great cannot live for long
For heaven cannot survive without her strong
So on a soft and silent evening she came
To steal away this man of fame

He too greeted her with a smile
And was swept off his worn tiles
At dawn the town rose in shock
Throwing to the sky riches and rocks

Pleading the heavens to return the man
Who'd left but 3 pennies and a can
Soon they sat around a solemn grave
Bound to their seats as though chained like slaves

Chained, yet adrift in memories
Whispers of wisdom in the breeze
Reminiscing the wise old man
With only 3 pennies in his can

For what can we do except reminisce
The touch and words of those we miss
Share our stories and share our pain
Hoping for a reality where they
live again

"Just a few more days" they plead
Consumed by grief and greed
Once again the villagers burst into tears
Dreading a future without him near

For in their heart there came a hole
Where once lived a beautiful soul
Yet how foolish were they
To think he forever went away
Without leaving them a gift
To help them cross this rift



Inside his humble hamlet
Away from their ravage and regret
He kept a book paper bound
Wisdom stored safe and sound

The solution to grief
Wrapped in a plaid 'kerchief
Packed into a small sonnet
Composed right at sunset

"Antidote to pain
Regret under any name
Simply pure love"

In disbelief stood the village
Speechless as though on stage
For their love was immense
Yet their grief just as intense

"Well the grammar's a bit off!"
Joked a villager in a sorrow stricken huff
For the words so clear, so plain
Didn't once quell the pain

The pain of separation
and grief and isolation
Of loss and denial
Rising up like bile

Love didn't banish this pain
Rather it deserved much disdain
For love was the reason
The were grieving this season

Spring wasn't the time to mourn
Nor the time for pyres to burn
Nay it was time for the flowers to bloom
For birth to lace the loom

Bitingly bitter was this betrayal
For right on birth's trail
Death had ploughed his way
Into the birth of a gentle day

How viciously they cursed
This figure who traversed
Through their bustling roads
Oh how terribly they woe'd
The loss of the wise wise man
Who had but 3 pennies in a can





And so the seconds bled
Into hours they sped
Scarlet, bloodshot eyes
Looking up into the skies

And the skies looked back down
Perhaps with a muffled frown
Their misery and malice all abstruse
In agony and anger profuse

For how could they wail
And weep and flail
When the antidote to their sorrow
Was as near as tomorrow

The solution to grief
Sat wrapped in a plaid 'kerchief
Right under their nose
Packed into a little prose

For love always heals
And soothes and seals
And love is never to blame
In this ridiculous game

Love isn't a cruel decree
Or a broken, bent plea
Its living proof of joy
Not a wicked vicious ploy

For every tear that tumbles
Is a measure all jumbled
A measure of what had been
The bliss, and blessed serene

An echo of days spent
Worthy enough to lament
Love and grief all symmetric
A crashing, chaotic metric

They must learn to embrace
Not ravage and replace
The savage seething storms
That keep their memories warm

For the greatest privilege we hold
Finer than all the world's gold
Is the privilege to mourn
When love is most forlorn.

- AVIKA RAHUL MUNDRA
IB YEAR - 1



FROM FORKS TO FINGERS

PART-2 [PART -1 IN ISSUE 25]

STUTI AGARWAL

IB- YEAR I

No exaggeration, it was real bliss. And from that day I promised myself that there is no turning back. Now, when I scoop up the rice drowned in sambar, or pinch the roti and sabzi between my fingers, I don't just taste it, I experience a manifold explosion of gastronomical greatness.

The heat of the sambar, the texture of the rice, the stickiness of the ghee - all these just add to the experience. It isn't just about connecting with my culture; it's mainly about the actual experience of eating. The first time I truly allowed myself to experience eating with my hands, the feeling was intimate. I realised I was missing out on the fascinating art of gastronomy. Now, I feel like I am having a face-to-face conversation with my food. And trust me, a spoon can never translate that conversation!

It's funny how we associate ceremony with silverware and etiquette with utensils. But it's really about respect, isn't it? Respect for the food, the people who made it and the tradition it stems from. Eating with your hands DOES NOT make you uncivilised, it makes you alert and allows you to truly feel - or eat - the moment.

Now, I eat dal makhni with my hands even at restaurants. Scandalous? Perhaps. But flavour hits differently when culture meets finger-licking confidence. These days, whenever I go back home and see Papa eating with his hands, I no longer look away. We sit cross-legged, eating from our thalis and laughing. The judgment has melted away like ghee on hot rice. Thank you, Annakshetra for transforming my disgust into delight and my rebellion into reverence.

THE FIRE OF YOUTH

Millenia of Life and death have gone by,
Colossal Empires have risen and died
And there we sit on our throne, confused and alive
about our puny, insignificant sorrows keeping us in dire.

Not a soul has the courage to complain and refuse
about the flaws of our lives, which our ancestors knew
From the way we sleep to the way we walk
and from the way we live to the way we talk.

The fiery heart of youth has dimmed
while from the goblet of poison, some of our 'wise' old have sipped
we console ourselves waiting for prophecy to arrive
Well I say, "To hell with Prophecy! On the epicenter we must strike!"





The old shall die one day, but to the youth I proclaim!
This planet and her people are ours to save.
Differences will exist, but evil gives not a damn!
This Darkness shall be gone, if we just remember to turn on our lamps.

And so, time shall come and time shall go,
but our existence here shouldn't be a mere shadow
So get up from your throne and start the fight
for all the wise and the known shall join with their might.

To complete this poem, with finesse and hope
I call upon the exploits of Rama's and Krishna's galore
From their defeat of Adharma, to their unparalleled virtue
To them I bow down and pray for strength, clarity and vision to us, the Youth.

- K Rampraneel Reddy | IB 2

Mahabharat

THE TERRIBLE TWINS

In the middle of a war, stands a chariot with four white horses. A man kneels in front of a blue figure, the brave Arjuna, at the feet of the beautiful Krishna.

Oh, but why is he so sad? We see Krishna lift him from his knees and say, well, something that changes Arjuna completely!
Well, welcome to the Gita, a 700 shloka and the way to live life.

Hey! Look, Arjuna is speaking. Thus Partha spoke "You know Krishna, many men do sinful things, even if they know it is wrong. As if an unstoppable force is making them do it."

Thus the lord spoke "Partha, these are the twin ogres - Kāma (Desire) and Krodha (Anger). The whole sequence is there. First, when we see something, we want it for ourselves. When we don't get it, we become angry and our mind loses its sense."

Hence, the Lord warns us of these dangers, and reminds us of what may happen. He also gives us the solution to them. It is up to us to use it.



- Hridan Mishra | Grade 5

SPIRITUALITY AND THEATRE

INDIA'S ANCIENT
SCIENCE OF
EMOTION

Ayush Sreenath Bhashyam
IB Year-1

Everyone today talks about 'raw acting,' as if the only way to prove emotion is to break down on camera, shake, cry, fall apart, and call it authenticity.

Pain has become the currency of performance. If you're not trembling under the weight of your emotions, are you even acting? But...here's the crazy part - India mastered emotional performance long before method acting and breakdown culture became fashionable, and it did so without glorifying chaos or trauma.

Our theatre wasn't born in studios, it was born in temples, rituals, and philosophy. The Natyashastra treated theatre like a spiritual and psychological science instead of a talent show. We learnt the true art of emotional intelligence before the world had its fancy acting coaches.

The foundation was basic; emotion isn't supposed to swallow the actor, the actor is supposed to shape it.

Today, a lot of performers behave with a baser mentality - the more you suffer, the more "real" it looks.

Classical Indian theatre had a completely different approach - if you lose yourself, you lose the performance. Actors trained breath, gaze, posture, memory, tone, rhythm and so much more. It wasn't about being overwhelmed, but about being aware.

You didn't break down to show grief, you studied grief until you could guide someone else into feeling it.

Modern acting, especially in the age of reels and algorithm-driven applause, often rewards emotional noise over emotional meaning. But breakdown isn't depth, and panic isn't truth. Classical Indian performers understood something many performers forget today; emotion without control isn't honesty... it's just noise. True artistry is walking into an emotion and walking back out with your core intact.

This is why the Navarasa remains such a genius system. Nine core feelings, not to shrink emotions, but to understand them. To practice entering them, and just as importantly, practice exiting them. Imagine telling a modern day acting class that the real test isn't in just feeling deeply, it's in returning to neutrality after.

And let's be honest, we all love a loud performance sometimes. Cinema provided us with that catharsis. But subtlety has vanished like it never had worth. We've reached a point where silence feels like weakness and restraint feels like lack of effort. But the irony is, our own tradition shows that silence cuts through sharper than a scream. A controlled tear can mean more than a meltdown. A pause can hurt more than a monologue. Real power isn't in volume, it's in intention.

We don't come from emotional surrender, we build through emotional architecture. This isn't a nostalgic plea to return to mud stages and temple courtyards, and it isn't about rejecting modern techniques and screen realism. It's a reminder that Bharat has a performance toolkit older and more psychologically advanced than the majority of the world's acting philosophies.

And instead of bending ourselves to every western performance trend, maybe we should revive what was always ours. Method acting broke bodies and minds, while our tradition built emotional resilience, awareness and recovery. That, if anything, is lightyears ahead of its counterparts.

So maybe the future of Indian acting isn't about chasing emotional fracture as proof of depth. Maybe, it's about relearning how to feel - without shattering, expressing - without losing the self, and to perform without self harm disguised as passion.

In a world addicted to emotional spectacle, our tradition holds something truly radical; The greatest actors are not those who fall apart, but those who can break on stage and return whole, without needing applause for their wounds.

If Bharat's theatre tradition tells us anything, it's this:

The real master isn't the one who loses themselves for the role, it's the one who returns, more alive.

And if that's where Bharat's acting is heading, then we aren't going backwards, we're circling back to the front.



Swastika - The Truth!

Chief

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

Reclaim Your Symbol. Protect Your Heritage.

A symbol of peace, or a symbol of hate?



Your heritage is being defined by its abusers. When you stay silent, the lie wins. It's time to tell the truth

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

This is the SWASTIKA.

"Su" (good) + "Asti" (to exist). Meaning "All is well."



For over 10,000 years, it has been our sacred symbol of well-being, good fortune, and divinity.

#LearnWithCrossroads

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

This is OUR heritage.

Swastika = Sacred | Auspicious | Hindu



It represents:

- The Four Vedas: The foundation of our knowledge.
- The Four Goals of Life: Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha.
- Lord Vishnu's divine power.
- Lord Ganesha's blessing to remove obstacles.

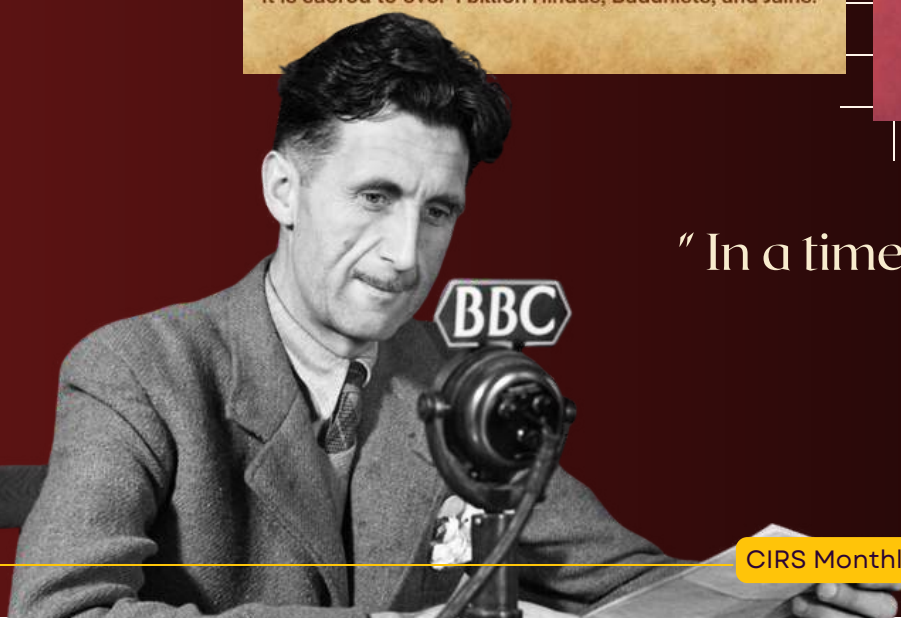
It is sacred to over 1 billion Hindus, Buddhists, and Jains.

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

This is the HAKENKREUZ (Hooked Cross).

In 1920, the Nazi party stole and distorted our symbol. They twisted it into an emblem of genocide, racism, and pure hate.

They are NOT the same.

"In a time of deceit, telling the truth is a revolutionary act."

George Orwell

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

Hakenkreuz is not a Swastika

Calling the Nazi symbol a "Swastika" is a slander against your culture. It's like calling a burning cross just "a cross."

Every time it's misidentified, our 10,000-year history of peace is erased by 75 years of hate. This is how heritage is misrepresented. This is how it's lost.



Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

Your Mission: EDUCATE. RECLAIM. PROTECT.

The West's understanding will not change on its own. We must change it.



This isn't just history. This is your living culture. It's time to defend it.

#LearnWithCrossroads

Chief #THERIGHTVOICE

HOW TO PROTECT YOUR DHARMA:



- CORRECT respectfully. When someone misuses the word, say: "You mean the hakenkreuz, the Nazi symbol. Our Swastika is a 10,000-year-old symbol of peace."
- SHARE the truth. Post about its real meaning. Don't be afraid to use it in its sacred context.
- NEVER be ashamed. This is your heritage. It is profound, ancient, and powerful.

Chief #TheRightVoice

HOW TO PROTECT YOUR DHARMA:



It's time to own our narrative. Share this now.

Chief

"Tales of the hunt will always glorify the hunter, until the lion learns to write"

African Proverb



The Master - Genesis of Spiritual Leadership

An insight into the life of a spiritual giant - Swami Tapovan ji Maharaj

Br.Sanatan Chaitanya | Spiritual Guide



"He came from nowhere, existed everywhere, and ultimately went to be everywhere.", these were the words of Pujya Gurudev, when he was asked about his Guru Tapovan ji Maharaj. Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda was a titan of transformation who ushered in a new dawn which re-shaped the entire world. However, every world - changing movement originates from a single powerful spark. Swami Tapovanam, the sage of Uttarkashi was that infinite radiance which sparked a revolutionary global spiritual renaissance.

Swami ji was the living embodiment of the quote - 'Silent minds are the most eloquent minds'; he consciously chose the austere silence of the Himalayas over worldly commendation. Even today, his story of inner discipline and deep wisdom serves as an inspiration to countless youngsters who aspire to become more than themselves.

Every great society is made up of great individuals who strive to grow beyond the circumstances of birth and leave their mark on the world.

A scenic view of a mountain range with a small village in the foreground. The mountains are covered in green vegetation, and the village has several buildings with colorful roofs. The sky is clear and blue.

Tapovan Maharaj was no different, while his earthly journey began as Subrahmanya Iyer in Palakkad, Kerala, his was not a life destined for ordinary pursuits. From his earliest days, he possessed an intellect that shone with uncommon brilliance, allowing him to effortlessly plumb the depths of Sanskrit and scholastic learning. Yet, the allure of worldly success and the commendation it brings held no sway over his vibrant spirit.

He was pulled by an unquenchable, inner spiritual thirst. This profound calling led him to renounce the world, embracing the sacred path of *sannyas*, and guiding his feet to the holy solitude of Uttarkashi, nestled deep within the Garhwal Himalayas. It was in this austere sanctuary that his entire existence transformed into a singular, rigorous sadhana.

He chose a life of majestic simplicity, wholly dedicating every breath to the intense contemplation and ultimate realization of Vedanta—the final, philosophical pinnacle of Hindu Dharma. This unwavering, singular commitment to the path was so complete that he became the living embodiment of his name: Tapovanam, the 'Forest of Austere Spiritual Practice.' To see Tapovan Maharaj merely as a silent ascetic, however, is to miss the profound eloquence that flowed from his realized mind. He was, in truth, a masterful poet and writer, a conduit for the very wisdom he embodied. His crowning literary jewel is Ishwara Darshan (The Vision of God). This is no mere collection of verses; it is a remarkable Sanskrit symphony, where the ultimate, non-dual truth of Vedanta is captured with breathtaking poetic beauty, yet grounded in unshakeable intellectual rigor.

So too, in his Himavad Mahima (The Glory of the Himalayas), his words articulate the majestic awe of the mountains. He saw in those silent, towering peaks the very visible form—the awesome, breathing embodiment—of the cosmic truth he sought. His writings stand as irrefutable proof that the true spiritual pursuit is not an abandonment of intellect or art, but is, in fact, their highest and most sublime expression.

When we look at Tapovan Maharaj's life, we find that in spite of having devotees in powerful places with a lot of wealth, Tapovan ji exudes dispassion and detachment in his every breath. It is believed that, once the king and queen of Nepal had visited Tapovan ji Maharaj and offered to build an ashram for him to reside. Maharaj refused the same, telling them how he is happy staying in his humble abode at Uttarkashi. This holds a profound teaching, 'Seek Excellence, Not acclaim' - in a world which thrives on validation and recognition, Tapovan Maharaj's life is a testament to the power of inner worth. He drives us to focus on building our character and intellectual rigor, and find true value in discipline, merit and sacrifice, not in the number of followers we accumulate.

A popular spiritual adage says 'a realised master's qualities are the spiritual goals of an aspiring seeker'. Tapovan Maharaj's entire life was a sadhana, he gives us the insight that greatness in any field is just the manifestation of consistent, focussed discipline. Tapovan ji Maharaj inspires us to embrace austerity, to look upon it as a forge which shapes us into a formidable force of excellence and greatness.

To speak of Tapovan Ji Maharaj as a mere "individual" is to fundamentally misunderstand the sheer magnitude of his being. He was not a person; he was an institution of true wisdom, a silent, immovable force. He was that "veritable mirror" of pure truth in which a "fiery journalist," with his worldly skepticism and a hazy knowledge who came to face him, saw reflected back not a man, but the resolute image of a sage, a towering beacon of inspiration who stood utterly unfazed by the world, a spiritual giant.

The world, in its preoccupation with public acclaim, might even dare to wonder: what was the contribution of a sage who sought no "public," who built no movement? Well! Let all who ask understand: Tapovan Maharaj's vibhooti—his divine, manifested glory—was not a "public career." His singular, world-changing legacy was the careful and complete mentoring of the one who would become our Gurudev, Pujya Swami Chinmayananda. He did not himself spark the global renaissance; he forged the infinite radiance that would.

*“Real peace is not found in forests or caves —
it is in the stillness of one’s own mind.
~ Swami Tapovan Maharaj*



SHACKLES OF AN EMPIRE

India's true freedom is an unfinished project - Hiya Deep Dave | XII MGMT



India's 1947 independence was a significant political victory but initiated an unfinished revolution. Although self-rule was achieved, true intellectual and cultural decolonization was not pursued. British institutions and worldview persist, leading to mental colonization. A key symptom is the dominance of the English language, which serves as a social currency indicative of class, intelligence, and modernity, binding India to its imperial past. The phenomenon originates from Macaulay's 1835 colonial blueprint, aimed at creating an "Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste." By prioritizing English and neglecting native languages like Sanskrit, the post-independence state continued this linguistic displacement. The education system remains linked to colonial structures, producing compliant administrators instead of promoting civilizational pride or indigenous knowledge.

Textbooks often glorify British reforms while minimizing India's significant contributions to ancient sciences and philosophies, reinforcing an inherited inferiority complex. The governance and legal system reflects British common law and retains colonial laws, showing a lack of ideological transformation for a sovereign republic. Post-independence, the ruling elite's choices, and a unrivalled adoption of a Eurocentric model influenced by European Enlightenment and Fabian socialism, further marginalized India's spiritual and dharmic traditions. This post-modernist approach maintained colonial structures while sidelining indigenous knowledge systems, creating an intellectual elite disconnected from its cultural heritage. One of the major aims of Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda was to engage this intellectually disjointed youth with their heritage and culture. In spite of our best efforts the ideological shift seems to be a dominant force in the life of our youth.

The ideological shift in India accelerated due to endorsement by key institutions which deal with education and information. Additionally, Bollywood contributed to cultural re-engineering of the Indian mind through glorification of non-indigenous ideas and cultures, creating a bias against native assertiveness. This cultural betrayal has left India intellectually dependent on foreign narratives. As we near the end of the 2nd century of Macaulay's education model, it is imperative that we introspect on what led to a re-framing of Indian history through economic and class conflict, promoting rigid narratives that diminished national pride and ancient Hindu achievements while politicizing conflicts and change those ideas with positive ones. The article argues for a civilizational renaissance to reclaim India's historical and cultural identity through a re-engagement with Indic knowledge systems.

CAPTURES

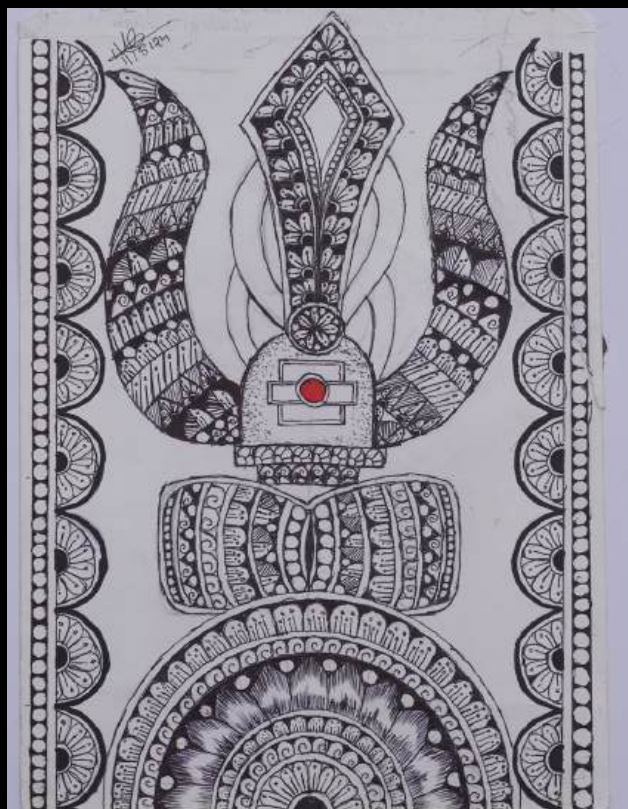
SURABAYA... Puti, saya kenalkan sama arek-arek Suroboyo," ajak Wali Kota Surabaya Tri Rismaharini kepada bakal calon wakil gubernur (cawagub) Jatim Puti Guntur Soekarno di car free day (CFD) Taman Bungkul Puti naik ke pangkajung yang dipakai instruktur aerobik. Puti pun berkenan memperkenalkan diri. "Mohon doa restunya. Saya dan bakal maju untuk mem...







CREATIVE CORNER



Manvi T - IX



S. Rithesh - VIII



Abarna Renu - XII



Lokhithj - X



Shaurya B - XI



Ashmi A - VIII



Prahallad S- XI



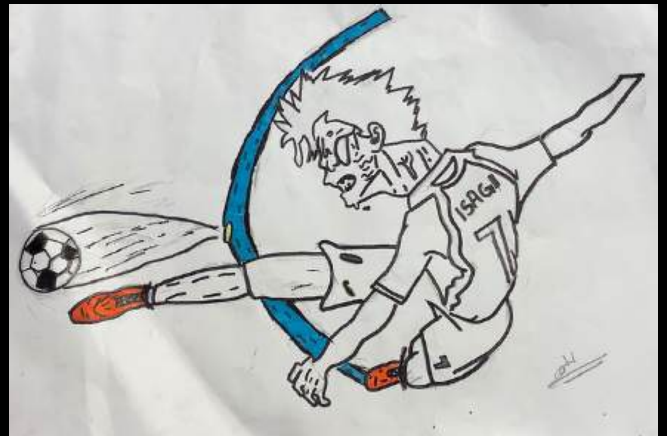
Aarush K- VI



Garvit - IX



Piraisoodan - VIII



Hardik - VII



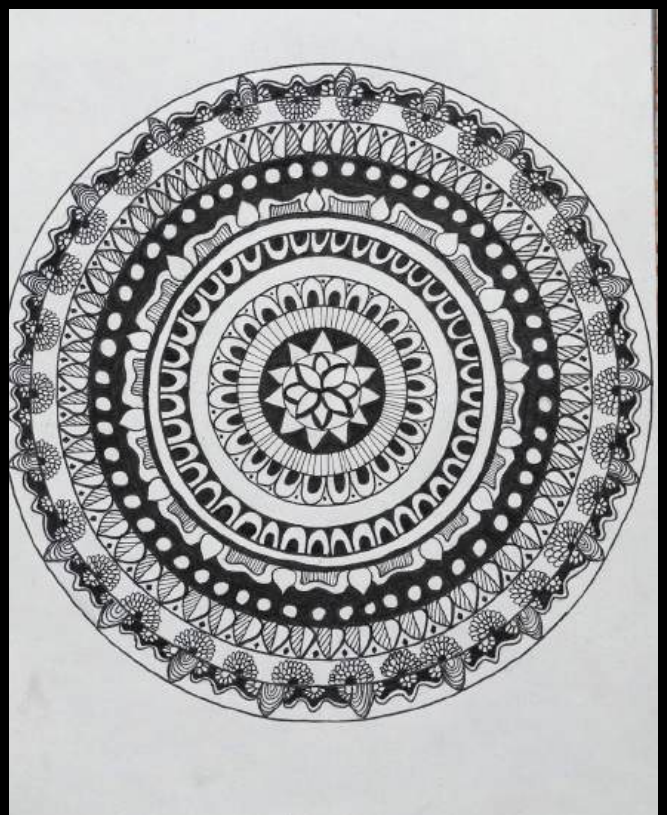
Govardhan PM - VII



Aaradhya Goyal - V



Sahashra - VI



Kanushree A - XI

Harnessing Youth Potential Through Yajna Spirit | October 2025

Exemplifying this quality is our one and only, Shri Ram! From serving with courage and sacrificing his throne for Dharma. From accepting exile joyfully to fighting Ravana selflessly. His spirit, his valor, his yajna were all for societal welfare. He is indeed - Maryada Purushottam.



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IN SOLIDARITY

We stand firmly in solidarity with the victims of the horrific bomb blast at Delhi. Our thoughts, prayers and heartfelt condolences are with everyone affected.

Any act of violence or terror against Bharat and its people is condemnable. These repeated attempts are aimed to spread hatred, fear and distrust in our own strength.

We pledge to demonstrate responsibility and unity. As our Gurudev so eloquently phrased, service to the country is the service to the lord of lords and devotion to the people is the devotion to the supreme self.

Let us Stay Strong. Stay Safe. Jai Hind.

Our gratitude to the CIRS management for giving flight to our initiative.

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